



(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Ranney

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(54) **HYDRANGEA PLANT NAMED ‘NCHA1’**

(50) Latin Name: *Hydrangea arborescens*
Varietal Denomination: **NCHA1**

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patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **12/313,080**

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(51) **Int. Cl.**
A01H 5/00 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.** **Plt./250**

(58) **Field of Classification Search** **Plt./250**
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

GTITM UPOVROM Citation for ‘NCSUHA1’ as per CA PBR
08-6471, filed Nov. 28, 2008.*

* cited by examiner

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

‘NCHA1’ is a new *Hydrangea* plant particularly distin-
guished by having a medium-sized, rounded, multi-stemmed
shrub, a unique combination of compound, corymb inflores-
cences with prevalent sterile flowers and rose to pink colored
sepals, is disclosed.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Genus and species: *Hydrangea arborescens*.

Variety denomination: ‘NCHA1’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention comprises a new and distinct cultivar
of *Hydrangea*, botanically known as *Hydrangea arbores-*
cens, and hereinafter referred to by the cultivar name
‘NCHA1’. This new *Hydrangea* was developed through a
breeding program at Mills River, N.C. ‘NCHA1’ originated
as an open pollinated (F2) seedling from *H. arborescens*
cultivar ‘H2005-045-061’ (unpatented) that was grouped in
an isolation block with full sibling plants of the same parent-
age.

The first asexual propagation of ‘NCHA1’ was carried out
in June 2006 by rooting stem cuttings at Mills River, N.C.,
USA and has been asexually reproduced repeatedly by veg-
etative cuttings in North Carolina over a two year period.
‘NCHA1’ roots readily from softwood cuttings treated with a
basal dip of 2,500–4,000 ppm indole butyric acid (potassium
salt) in water. ‘NCHA1’ has been found to retain its distinc-
tive characteristics through successive asexual propagations.

Plant Breeder’s Rights for this cultivar have been applied
for. ‘NCHA1’ has not been made publicly available more than
one year prior to the filing of this application.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following are the most outstanding and distinguishing
characteristics of this new cultivar when grown under normal
horticultural practices at Mills River, N.C., USA.

1. Medium-sized, rounded, multi-stemmed shrub;
2. Rose to pink colored sepals; and

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3. Compound, corymb inflorescences with prevalent sterile
flowers.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

This new *Hydrangea* plant is illustrated by the accompa-
nying photographs which show the plant’s form, foliage and
inflorescences. The colors shown are as true as can be rea-
sonably obtained by conventional photographic procedures.
The photographs were taken on 2-year-old plants in July
2008, growing under landscape conditions in Arden, N.C.

FIG. 1 Shows the mature plant habit.

FIG. 2 Shows a close-up of the mature inflorescences.

FIG. 3 Shows the size and color ranges of mature inflores-
cences.

DESCRIPTION OF THE NEW CULTIVAR

The following detailed description sets forth the distinctive
characteristics of ‘NCHA1’. The detailed description was
taken on 2-year-old plants growing under landscape condi-
tions in Arden, N.C., in July 2008. Color references are to The
R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal Horticultural Society of
London (R.H.S.), 2001 Edition.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

Classification:

Botanical name.—*Hydrangea arborescens*.

Common name.—Smooth *Hydrangea*.

Parentage: ‘NCHA1’ originated as an open pollinated (F2)
seedling from *H. arborescens* cultivar ‘H2005-045-061’
(unpatented) that was grouped in an isolation block with
full sibling plants of the same parentage (‘Eco Pink Puff’
(unpatented)×‘H2004-006-012’ (unpatented)).

Plant description:

Classification.—Shrub.

Type.—Deciduous.

Form.—Multi-stemmed.
Shape.—Rounded plant habit.
Usage.—Adaptable landscape shrub.
Height (from top of soil including inflorescences).—
About 100 cm. 5
Diameter (including inflorescences).—About 100 cm.
Branching habit.—Freely branching with as many as
100 or more terminal shoots per plant.
Shoots.—Length: 50 cm to 100 cm Diameter: 0.3 cm to
1.0 cm Internode length: 5 cm to 15 cm Texture: 10
Glabrous Color: RHS 146C.
Time to produce a finished plant having inflores-
cences.—3 months to 6 months.
Time to initiate and develop roots.—3 weeks to 4 weeks.
Leaves: 15
Form.—Simple.
Arrangement.—Opposite.
Number.—10 to 25 leaves per shoot.
Length.—6 cm to 10 cm.
Width.—5 cm to 8 cm. 20
Shape.—Broadly ovate.
Apex.—Acuminate.
Base.—Cordate to rounded
Margin.—Dentate to serrate.
Venation pattern.—Pinnate, opposite to sub-opposite. 25
Venation color (both surfaces).—RHS 191 B.
Texture.—Upper surface: Glabrous Lower surface:
Slightly pubescent.
Immature leaf color in summer.—Upper surface: RHS
138A Lower surface: RHS 138B. 30
Mature leaf color in summer.—Upper surface: RHS
139A Lower surface: RHS 138A.
Petioles.—Length: 1.5 cm to 4 cm Diameter: 0.2 cm
Color: Upper surface: RHS 181B Lower surface:
RHS 146C. 35
Inflorescence:
Appearance or form.—Fertile (approximately 600) and
sterile flowers (approximately 600) arranged on indi-
vidual hemispherical or dome-shaped terminal, com-
pound corymbs. 40
Corymb.—Diameter: 8 cm to 20 cm Height: 5 cm to 12
cm Season: Continuously flowering from late May to
early August in Arden, N.C. Quantity: Often 100 or
more corymbs per plant over the summer Longevity:
Individual corymbs are showy for approximately 4 45
weeks.
Sterile flowers.—Petals, pistils, and stamens are greatly
reduced (<0.5 mm) and insignificant Buds: Shape:
Round Diameter: 0.1 cm to 0.2 cm Color: RHS 187C
Sepals: Number: 2 to 4 Length: 0.5 cm to 0.7 cm 50
Width: 0.3 cm to 0.5 cm Shape: Lanceolate to oval
Apex: Acute Base: Attenuate Margin: Entire Texture:
Smooth/glabrous Color (when expanding, both sur-
faces): RHS 187C Color (when fully expanded, both

surfaces): Ranges from RHS 68D to RHS 68C, and
from RHS N66D to RHS N66C.
Fertile flowers.—Sepals and petals are greatly reduced
(<0.5 mm) and insignificant Buds: Shape: Round
Diameter: 0.1 cm to 0.2 cm Color: RHS 186B Flower
size: Width: 0.1 cm to 0.2 cm Height: 0.2 cm to 0.3
cm.
Reproductive organs:
Pistils.—2, fused Color: RHS 155B throughout Length:
0.2 cm Stigma: Blunt Stigma diameter: 0.025 cm
Style length: 0.1 cm Ovary shape: Rounded Ovary
diameter: 0.1 cm.
Stamens.—Number: 10 Anther: Shape: Rounded, fusi-
form Length: 0.025 cm long Color: RHS 158D Fila-
ment length: 0.2 cm Filament color: RHS 155B Pol-
len: Scarce.
Fruit/seed set: Seeds are minute, dust-like.
Disease and insect resistance: No significant disease or insect
pests have been observed.

COMPARISON WITH PARENTAL LINES AND
KNOWN CULTIVAR

‘NCHA1’ is distinguished from cultivar ‘H2005-045-061’
by having a compound, corymb inflorescence with prevalent
sterile florets.
‘NCHA1’ has a unique combination of compound, corymb
inflorescences with around 600 prevalent sterile flowers and
rose to pink colored sepals not found in other known com-
mercial cultivars of *Hydrangea arborescens*. Table 1 shows
comparisons between ‘NCHA1’ and two other commercial
hydrangea cultivars, ‘Annabelle’ (unpatented) and ‘Eco Pink
Puff’ (unpatented).

TABLE 1

COMPARSION TO COMMERCIAL CULTIVARS			
Characteristic	‘NCHA1’	‘Annabelle’	‘Eco Pink Puff’
Inflorescence corymb diameter	8 cm to 20 cm	26 cm to 32 cm	6 cm to 10 cm
Inflorescence corymb height	5 cm to 12 cm	22 cm to 26 cm	2 cm to 6 cm
Sterile flowers number per corymb	600	1,650	0 to 4
Mature sepal color when fully expanded	Rose to pink (RHS 68D to RHS 68C and RHS N66D to RHS N66C)	Ivory (RHS 155C)	Pale Pink (RHS 69C)

I claim:
1. A new and distinct cultivar of *Hydrangea* plant as shown
and described herein.

* * * * *



FIG. 1



FIG. 2

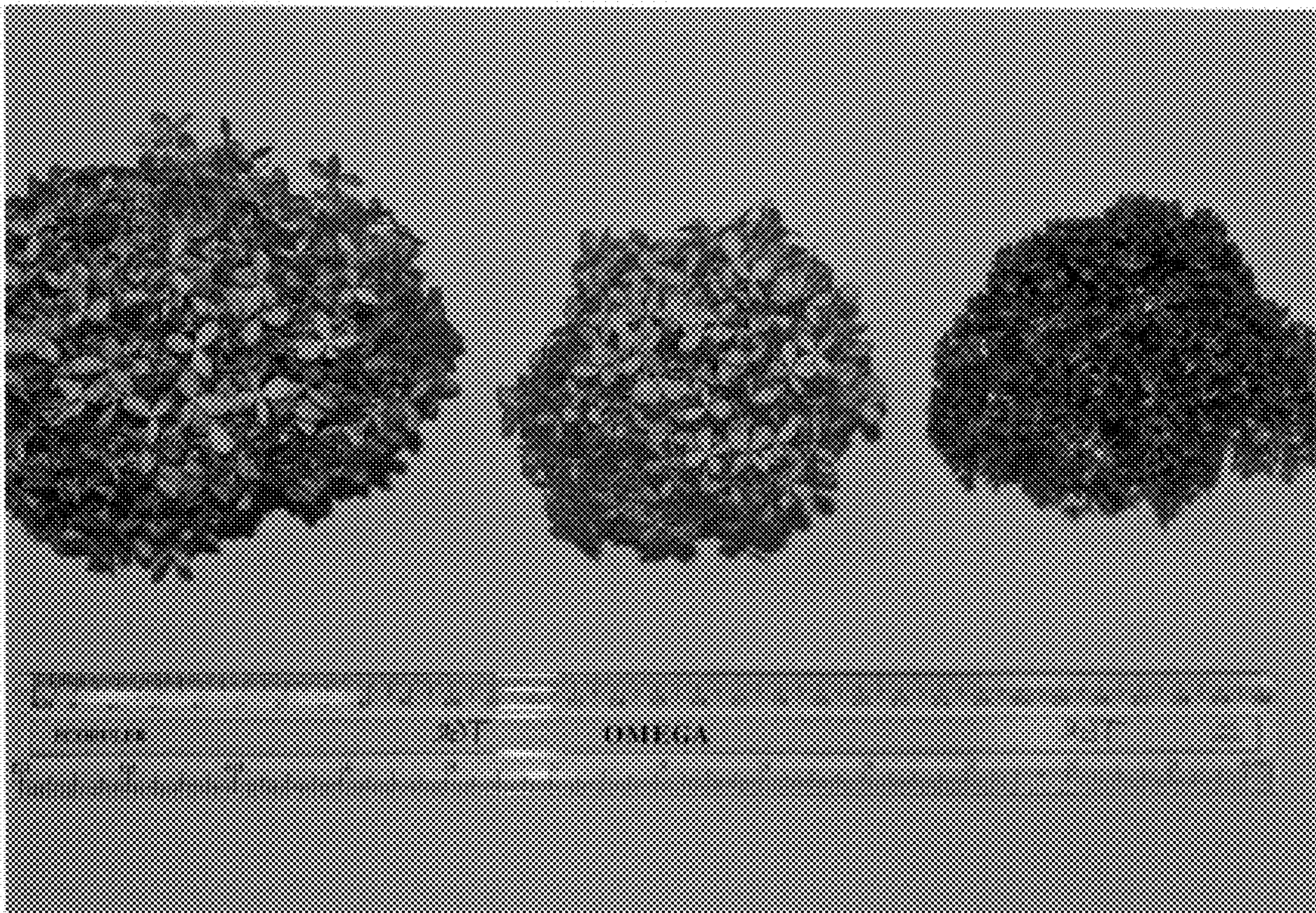


FIG. 3